PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Lexus LX 470

1998–2007 · J100 · UZJ100 · 2UZ-FE

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **AHC health**
  Cycle the truck through Low, Normal and High and watch it level. Look for fluid at the actuators and lines. Check the reservoir level in High and in Low. One IH8MUD member says that if pressures and heights are in spec, a 7-graduation difference means the globes are shot. A harsh, jiggly ride points the same way. Find out when the fluid was last flushed.

- [ ] **Timing belt records**
  The 2UZ-FE uses a timing belt with a 90k-mile service. Forum regulars say to confirm the 90k or 180k service has been done if the truck is near those mileages, and to have the water pump, idlers and tensioner done at the same time.

- [ ] **Ticks at cold start**
  A tick that fades as the engine warms is often a cracked driver's-side exhaust manifold, which CarSpec calls common on the 2UZ. IH8MUD members warn that the same sound can be a spark plug working loose, so check the plugs before blaming the manifold.

- [ ] **Brake warning lights**
  The 100 Series uses a high-pressure brake booster pump and accumulator instead of a vacuum booster. ABS and BRAKE lights plus a warning tone, or a pedal that sinks, mean a scan-tool diagnosis, not a guess. IH8MUD ran a poll on total brake failures, so treat it seriously.

- [ ] **Steering and front end**
  Check for power-steering leaks at the rack, play in the steering and torn CV boots. Lexus issued a ball-joint inspection TSB in 2002. Confirm that the 2010 steering-shaft recall (2003–2007 trucks) was done.

- [ ] **1998–1999 throttle gremlins**
  Slee lists accelerator and throttle position sensor faults on 1998–1999 trucks that can leave the truck not responding to the throttle. Make sure the throttle response is clean on the test drive.

- [ ] **Rust and use**
  Forum members report plenty of rusty trucks from the northern US. Get underneath with a light. Like any Land Cruiser, a high-mileage truck with full records beats a low-mileage truck with none.

- [ ] **Starter health**
  A slow or intermittent crank usually means worn starter contacts. The starter sits under the intake manifold, so it's a big job, and owners usually do it with the timing belt.

YEARS TO KNOW

2003	SWEET SPOT	Facelift. A750F five-speed automatic, 18-in wheels (275/60R18), VGRS steering, curtain airbags and ULEV-II certification at 235 hp. Forum regulars call 2003–05 the years to get, mostly for the five-speed.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Steering shaft snap ring**
  2003–2007 · NHTSA 10V-346
- ☐ **Side curtain airbag control module**
  2003–2006 · NHTSA 16V-065
- ☐ **Incorrect airbag fitted**
  2006 · NHTSA 17V-548
- ☐ **Daytime running lights too bright**
  1998–2005 · NHTSA 04V-434

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **VIN**
  US trucks start JTJHT00W. NHTSA's vPIC decoder reads them as the LX 470 with the 2UZ-FE engine, built in Toyota City. The 10th character is the model year (W = 1998, X = 1999, Y = 2000, 1 = 2001 through 7 = 2007).
- ☐ **LX vs Land Cruiser 100**
  Quad multi-reflector/projector headlamps, body cladding on the doors and quarter panels, backlit gauges, different wheels, and AHC with AVS standard from 1998.
- ☐ **Front differential**
  1998–1999 trucks have the weaker 2-pinion front diff. 2000-on trucks have the 4-pinion unit.
- ☐ **Steering-shaft recall**
  On 2003–2007 trucks, confirm recall 10V-346 was done. Lexus's VIN lookup or a dealer can confirm it.
- ☐ **2007 Limited Edition**
  400 built, all in Black Onyx with stone leather and special badging and scuff plates. Check for all three before paying a premium.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/lexus/lx470/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks